

# helm

## Working Session

10-12 Month Plan

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Farron Blanc | March 2026

# Team

## First 5 Hires

- Co-founder CPO (month 1)
- Full stack Staff Engineer (month 2)
  - Builder not manager, BaaS API KYC experience
  - Deary Hudson (or network)
- Contract to hire Front-end & DevOps (month 2-3)
  - Make Sept launch
  - Front-end (reg flow), DevSecOps
- Fractional CCO (month 4-5)
  - Disclosures, square off with Design partners reviews

## Open Thoughts

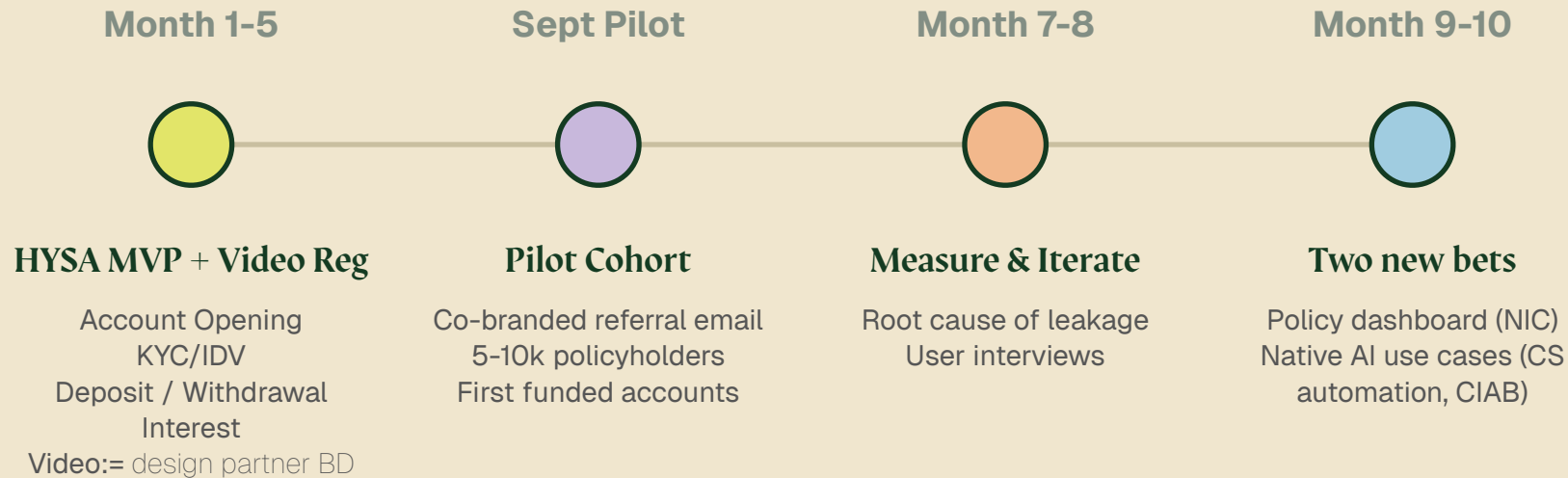
Will need to rely on Runyon + EJF + Optimist to open aperture | I run down every referral

VPEng/CTO defer until pre-Series A unless phenomenal comes along

Gerry the mission resonated well with candidates, Helm will be more nuanced



# Product

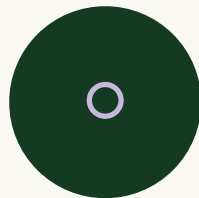


# Go To Market



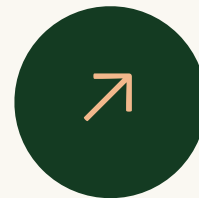
## Banner Life

Second OKR = getting signed -  
BUT default assumption is that  
they stall out/flake out



## NM or others

Advance NML  
Fast follow (parallel) SBLI / MoO



## IMO Distribution

Long term defensibility + drive  
carriers

Warrants = evangelists  
Crump (\$400M), LIBRA (\$500M),  
Accuquote (\$80M)



# Risks

| Risk                       | Detail                                                                                                                                                                                        | Mitigation                                                                                                                                                                 |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Co-Founder CPO Hire        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Helm needs to be world class in consumer fintech &amp; B2B2C onboarding.</li><li>Need THE best otherwise I'm wrong person for seat.</li></ul>           | Fly to SF spend 2 days<br>Overpay to secure                                                                                                                                |
| Banner stalls / walks away | <p>My base case assumption</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Cobalt distraction</li><li>Champion whose capital is finite</li><li>Compliance &amp; ARB sign-off takes months</li></ul> | <p>HYSA doesn't depend on Banner.<br/>Build regardless. Pivot to a new set of policyholders.</p> <p>Don't need carrier's permission if go through original distributor</p> |
| Seed needs co-lead         | Target June Closing with \$1.5M                                                                                                                                                               | List of 63 VCs                                                                                                                                                             |
| BaaS partner delays        | Expensive and assuming 3 month vs 6 month build                                                                                                                                               | Parallel path two BaaS                                                                                                                                                     |
| Compounding assumptions    | Strong Series A (\$10-20M) is predicated on user conversion, growth, deposits, retention                                                                                                      | Need pilot conversation                                                                                                                                                    |





Near the summit  
Series A

Mid-way up the  
mountain  
OKRs

Weekly  
Top 5

helm



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Navigate uncertain futures with certainty

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